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Revised edition · effective November 11, 2026

Membership Review Policy

Adopted by Resolution of the Board of Directors No. 2026-01 dated November 11, 2026. Effective November 11, 2026.

1. Purpose and Relationship to Other Documents

This Policy sets out the composition of the Membership Review Board, the timelines, and the voting, minutes and appeal procedures. The evaluation methodology (completeness check and criteria: Specialist — at least 3 of 4, all other categories — at least 5 of 7) is set out in the Membership Application Review Procedure; minutes are prepared on the form for the relevant category. Categories and their requirements are set out in the Membership Policy. This Policy applies together with the Bylaws (Sections 3.5, 4.1–4.7 and Article 14), the Conflict of Interest Policy and the Records Retention Policy.

2. Who Reviews Applications

Every membership application is reviewed by all members of the Membership Review Board. The Membership Review Board consists of all Board Members, Membership Selection & Quality Control, and any other Directors appointed to it by resolution of the Board. The Chair and the Secretary of the Review Board are appointed by the Board of Directors. The Chair of the Review Board (the President) and the Secretary of the Review Board (the Secretary) serve without a vote: the Chair conducts the review and has a casting vote only in the event of a tie; the Secretary keeps the minutes. The decision minutes are signed by all Review Board members, including the Chair and the Secretary. Each voting member votes independently and gives a written reason. The Board Member, Legal Affairs and the Board Member, Financial Affairs do not review or vote on applications. A quorum is at least 3 voting members who have not recused themselves.

3. Membership Categories

Specialist, Professional, Trainer / Educator, Business Owner, Brand / Company. Applications are assessed only against the criteria for the relevant category set out in the Membership Policy and the Membership Application Review Procedure.

4. Timelines

Timelines are counted in business days. A request for additional information stops the clock until the information is received.

Step	Who	Timeline
1. Completeness check and distribution to the Review Board	Secretary of the Review Board	2 business days

Step	Who	Timeline
2. Individual review and vote with a written reason	Each Review Board member	Specialist, Professional — 3 business days; Trainer / Educator, Business Owner, Brand / Company — 5 business days
3. Vote count, decision minutes and distribution by email	Secretary of the Review Board	1 business day
4. Signing the minutes	All Review Board members, including the Chair and the Secretary	1 business day
5. Written decision to the applicant	Secretary of the Review Board	1 business day
Total		**Specialist, Professional — up to 8 business days; other categories — up to 10 business days**

5. Voting and Decision

1. Each Review Board member reviews the application independently and votes "for", "against" or "abstain" with a brief reason; a vote "against" must state the criterion not met. A member may also propose requesting additional information or deferring the review.
2. A decision is made by a simple majority of the Review Board members who have not recused themselves. Until the admin panel is ready, votes are cast by replying to the Secretary's email.
3. In the event of a tie, the members discuss the application online and vote again within the overall timeline; if the tie remains, the Chair of the Review Board has the casting vote.
4. The Secretary prepares the decision minutes with a roll-call record of the votes and reasons and circulates them by email; all Review Board members, including the Chair and the Secretary, sign them within 1 business day.
5. Possible decisions (Section 4.4 of the Bylaws): Approved; Pending Additional Information; Deferred; Denied (stating the criterion not met). The applicant receives a written decision.

6. If a Member Does Not Vote on Time

- On the last day of the timeline, the Secretary sends a reminder.
- If no vote is received after the deadline, the decision is made on the votes cast, provided a quorum is present, and the missed vote is recorded in the minutes.
- Missing voting or signing deadlines more than three times in a year is grounds for Board discussion and consideration of removal from office.

7. Conflict of Interest

A Review Board member who has a connection with an applicant discloses it before voting, recuses himself or herself and does not discuss the application with other members. The Secretary records the recusal in the minutes. A conflict exists if the applicant is:

- a relative, business partner, employee, student or employer of the member;

- a client, competitor or supplier of the member's business;
- a client of Andreeva Consulting or its affiliated companies (the decision is made without the participation of Iuliia Andreeva and members related to her);
- a person from whom the member has received a gift, payment or other benefit in the past 12 months.

Review Board members do not accept payment, gifts or services from applicants and do not advise applicants on how to pass the review. Concealing a conflict is grounds for reconsideration of the decision and for consideration of removal from office.

8. Appeal

- An applicant may file a written appeal with the Secretary within 30 calendar days after notice of denial (Section 14.2 of the Bylaws permits a policy to set this period).
- The Board of Directors considers the appeal at its next meeting, and no later than 45 calendar days after filing; Review Board members who voted on the application do not vote on the appeal; the Board Member, Legal Affairs provides an opinion on procedural compliance. The decision on appeal is final.
- A new application after a denial may be submitted no earlier than 6 months later (Section 4.7 of the Bylaws).

9. Confidentiality and Retention

Review Board members handle applicant data only in the Association's systems, do not share it with third parties and do not discuss applications outside the Review Board and the Board. Decision minutes are kept in the admin panel (until it is ready, in Trello) for the periods set by the Records Retention Policy: review materials and minutes for at least 7 years, denied applications for at least 3 years.

10. Amendments

The Board may change the timelines and review procedure by resolution without re-signing the Board Member Agreement with Board members. Membership categories are changed in accordance with the Bylaws and the Membership Policy.

Secretary, full name	
Signature of the Secretary	
Date	